

different colour temperature levels. Also brightness and contrast can be changed via the OSD. Certain monitors allow you to create profiles which are basically a collection of all the various settings you have access to. This way you can have one profile for watching movies and another for reading etc.

Interface

The type of connector between your graphics card and your monitor does affect your picture quality. Certain interfaces have higher bandwidth and can support greater resolutions. The common interfaces in use today are VGA, DVI-D, DVI-I, HDMI and DP. VGA has been the standard for quite a long time and with higher resolution displays



being produced the need for an interface with greater bandwidth arose and the DVI interface was introduced. As for monitors with inbuilt audio, you could either use an audio jack to connect to your monitor or use an HDMI connector which has the video signal along with the audio signal. The newest entrant in the market is the Display Port which is quite similar to the HDMI interface. The difference lies in the security features and the increased bandwidth of the cable. Also the newer interfaces can carry signals for longer lengths as compared to previous generation interfaces.

What to buy

When buying a monitor remember the following points:

1. A huge monitor which only supports lower resolutions isn't worth buying.
2. Always stick to a standard aspect ratio.
3. The monitor must have an interface which is supported by your graphics card, using adaptors is one way out but using a low bandwidth adaptor on a high resolution monitor doesn't do justice,
4. Choose your panel type based on your usage scenario.
5. If you wish to wall mount your monitor then go for a monitor that supports the VESA standard. There are lots of mounts available which support this standard.